

Day 2 /Task 1

1. Fetch–Execute Cycle

The **Fetch–Execute Cycle** is the process by which the **CPU executes every instruction**. It repeats continuously until the program ends.

Steps:

1. **Fetch** – CPU fetches the next instruction from memory (RAM).
2. **Decode** – The Control Unit (CU) interprets the instruction.
3. **Execute** – The CPU performs the required operation.
4. **Repeat** – The Program Counter (PC) moves to the next instruction.

Key Components:

- **Program Counter (PC):** Stores the address of the next instruction.
- **Control Unit (CU):** Decodes and controls execution.
- **Registers:** Temporarily store data and instructions.
- **ALU:** Performs arithmetic and logical operations.

Flow:

Fetch → Decode → Execute → Repeat

2. Asynchronous Events

An **asynchronous event** is an event that occurs **unexpectedly while a program is running** (e.g., keyboard press, mouse click, timer, network message).

Types

Polling

- CPU continuously checks if an event has occurred.
- Simple but wastes CPU time.
- Suitable for simple systems.

Interrupt

- A device sends a signal to the CPU when an event occurs.
- CPU temporarily pauses the current task, handles the event, then resumes.
- Efficient and faster than polling.

Polling vs Interrupt

Polling	Interrupt
CPU repeatedly checks for events.	Device notifies the CPU.
Wastes CPU time.	Efficient CPU usage.
Slower response.	Faster response.
Simple implementation.	More efficient but slightly complex.

3. Subroutine (Method in Java)

A **subroutine** is a **reusable block of code** that performs a specific task. In Java, it is called a **method**.

How It Works:

1. Program calls the method.
2. Method executes its code.
3. Control returns to the calling program.

Advantages:

- Code reusability
- Reduces duplication
- Easier debugging
- Better program organization
- Improves readability and maintenance

★ Quick Revision (Exam Ready)

- **Fetch–Execute Cycle:** CPU executes instructions in the order **Fetch** → **Decode** → **Execute** → **Repeat**.

- **Asynchronous Event:** An unexpected event during program execution.
- **Polling:** CPU continuously checks for events.
- **Interrupt:** Device notifies the CPU only when an event occurs.
- **Subroutine (Method):** A reusable block of code used to perform a specific task and improve code organization.